

```
# Creates an array
var=(hello world how are you)
```

```
# Displays hello
echo $var
```

```
# Displays world
echo ${var[2]}
```

```
# Changes hello to howdy
var[0]=howdy
```

```
# Displays howdy
echo ${var[0]}
```

```
# Displays values – hello world how are
you
echo ${var[@]}
```

```
# Displays values – hello world how
are you
echo ${var[*]}
```

```
# Displays indexes or keys – 0 1 2 3 4
echo ${!var[@]}
```

```
# Displays indexes or keys – 0 1 2 3 4
echo ${!var[*]}
```

```
# Displays w
echo ${var:2:1}
```

```
# Displays 5, the number of variables in
the array
```

```
echo ${#var}
```

Bash is a minefield of careless errors

A shell script will execute like there is no tomorrow, irrespective of any errors it encounters. If a statement encounters an error and exits with a non-zero exit code, bash is happy to display any error message it wants but will nonchalantly continue to execute the subsequent statements.

If you try to use an undefined variable, bash will not treat it as an error. Bash will substitute an empty string and proceed. If you try `sudo rm -rf $non-existent-variable/`, the command evaluates to `sudo rm -rf /`. I have not tried it yet so I cannot tell what protections Linux has.

These shell behaviours are extremely dangerous. To fail early, place the following statement at the top of your scripts:

```
set -eu
```

That is, after the `#!/bin/bash` comment.

It is not possible to cover all Bash secrets in one article. In the next article, I will cover how Bash performs text expansions, substitutions and removals. **END** 🐧

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